

How I Use AI Coding Tools in My Daily Workflow

I use Claude Code, Cursor, and Codex as a fast pair — never as autopilot.

My loop on every ticket:

1. Inspect first.

Before writing anything, I have the AI map where the relevant logic actually lives and what depends on it. This prevents "fix one thing, break another" in an unfamiliar codebase.

2. Plan small.

I ask for a scoped plan tied to the ticket's acceptance criteria — not a rewrite. Smallest correct change wins.

3. Implement + read every line.

The AI drafts; I review all of it. No blind paste. I reject anything I can't explain.

4. Verify.

I run the app, test against the acceptance criteria, and check the edge cases the ticket implies.

5. Refine + hand off.

Small, reviewable diff plus a short written summary so QA and the next dev aren't guessing.

Why it matters for maintenance work: on live products, velocity is worthless if it creates regressions. This loop gives speed *and* safety — small diffs, clear handoffs, fewer surprises for QA.